

ties to demonstrate to their leadership all the great work our champions have done to meet their wider business goals, and ensure the team understands that our focus is on making them be successful, which can more easily be achieved if we are all aware of and in sync with leadership's expectations and objectives.

If you continue to have trouble engaging with your account, work with your colleagues in other departments to identify any existing relationships and collaborate on how to best engage with leadership in the account. For example, ask your sales colleagues if they have any existing relationships with the stakeholders in the account, or ask your CSM leadership if they know any peers at the customer.

As a CSM, you are responsible for ensuring the health and success of our customers. Providing regular updates on customer health is crucial to building trust and demonstrating the value of our solutions to executives. It is not uncommon for there to be gatekeeping when trying to get access to executives, but persistence and proactivity often are the key to succeed. It is important to continue to show value to the customer and handle common objections with these recommended responses.

Demonstrate Value and Speak the Language of Executives

Once you have established who the executive stakeholder at your company is, it's crucial to make a good first and continued impression. Building a relationship with the executive team can make or break your success with an account. CSMs typically have one meeting to show their value to an executive, and if the executive is not engaged in that first meeting they are unlikely to join future meetings.

It's important to understand why building a relationship with the executive team is important in the first place:

- Leadership clearly determines overall expectations and business goals
- Leadership is able to hold the customer team accountable
- Alignment with leadership allows the GitLab account team to course-correct when needed, rather than too late
- Leadership owns the budget and spending decisions, including renewal and expansion

One suggestion is to use the business model canvas to guide the conversation with executives. When communicating with executives, frame your messaging around the specific business outcomes they are trying to achieve. For example, if an executive is focused on reducing costs, communicate how our solutions can help reduce costs for their organization, while also allowing them to achieve more.

Sharing customer success stories is another excellent way to demonstrate the value and impact of our solutions to executives. Identify success stories that align with the executive's business objectives and share them during regular check-ins. This sharing of customer success stories can help build enthusiasm and support for our solutions and help identify opportunities to drive value.

It is also vital to highlight ROI to the executive team. Results prove to customers that they made a smart choice to invest their time, energy, and resources into your solution and that they received a return on their investment (ROI). Results show that you are solving problems

and positively impacting their business. Results mean you are able to "close the loop" and measure your impact. When communicating with executives, highlight the ROI of our solutions and how they can help the organization achieve its business goals.

Furthermore, executives often have a broad view of the organization and its goals. When communicating with executives, focus on the big picture and how our solutions fit into the larger organizational strategy. Focus on communicating how our solutions align with the executive's vision, mission, and values. Some example questions you can ask to identify what problems and priorities for the executive team are:

Impact Questions:

- What does it cost you when a vulnerability is found in production?
- What's the escalating cost the further down the remediation falls within your SDLC?
- Who is responsible for uncovering vulnerabilities?
- What are the implications when a vulnerability is found in production?
- What is the additional cost in people hours when a vulnerability is found in production?
- What is the legal risk to you when a vulnerability makes it into production?
- How does the speed of release impact the regulatory compliance motion?
- Do you have any metrics regarding the cost associated with a delay to a deployment?
- Do you have applications that generate revenue in which a delayed deployment also delays expected revenue?
- Do you have the ability to handle multiple deployments at once? Is there a deployment bottleneck based on resourcing?
- How has the quality of your software impacted your trading business?
- What risks do slow deployments create for your business?
- What budget disruptions have you seen historically related to slow software development?
- How does having multiple tools to learn and work with impact your ability to onboard new employees?

Value Questions:

- What if you could release a new version every week? How would that positively affect you?
- If our solution could help you iterate software deployment velocity by 50%, what would that do for you and your team?
- If you could build software 10% faster, how would that improve your revenue?
- How could your feedback loop improve with your stakeholders if you were able to release daily as opposed to every couple weeks?
- How about reducing the frustration from your dev team every time they push changes into production? What that make your team happier and eager to work faster?
- If you were to streamline your toolchain to improve cycle time, where would you start? What would you like to remain the same?
- What are you doing today to improve cycle time? Describe how you would like to improve cycle time.
- How would your business benefit if it were not constrained by the speed of releasing product changes?
- What is your ideal solution?

Establishing shared metrics for success with executives is another approach to building a successful partnership. These metrics should align with the executive's business objectives and

focus on the value our solutions provide to the customer. Work with the executive to identify key performance indicators (KPIs) that demonstrate the value of our solutions and track progress towards these metrics regularly.

- Use customer health scores, product usage data, satisfaction scores, renewal rates, and upsell opportunities to demonstrate how our solutions are contributing to the organization's success. For example, if a customer satisfaction score has improved since the implementation of our solutions, communicate that to the executives.
- Use data-driven insights: Executives rely on data to make informed decisions. Use data-driven insights to support your communication and demonstrate the value of our solutions. For example, use Gainsight health scores, Value Stream Analytics, and code quality metrics to demonstrate how our solutions contribute to the organization's success.

Finally, when working with executives, make sure to use language that executives will understand and avoid technical jargon. Use industry-specific terminology where appropriate, but be sure to provide context and explanations as needed. For example, if an executive is not familiar with a specific term or concept, explain it in simple terms that they will understand. Here are some common tips on communication with executives.

Continuous Engagement

Finally, it's essential to continuously improve your partnership with executives. Solicit feedback from the executive team on how the partnership is progressing and areas for improvement. Use this feedback to refine your approach and identify opportunities for growth and innovation. An annual EBR is a great opportunity to open this dialogue and learn ways in which we at GitLab can improve to make the customer's experience better. By implementing these best practices, CSMs can build strong partnerships with executives and drive successful outcomes for our customers.

It's recommended for each CSM to speak with an executive stakeholder at least annually, however each segment/region may warrant more frequent engagement, as follows:

- WIP - to be added

Additional Resources

The below resources are internal-only:

- Strategic Customer Engagement Workshop Recording
- Strategic Customer Engagement Workshop PPT
- Strategic Customer Engagement Issue
- Executive Communication Best Practice Resources

SECTION: customer-success/csm/fy23.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

FY23 Goals (Big Rocks)

Objective: Define the 3 'big rocks' to take on in FY23 with the overall goal of moving our team forwards. These rocks need to move us forwards as a team and as individuals, enabling us to scale, be impactful, and be inspired/fulfilled in our roles.

What are 'big rocks'?

As outlined in this article, they are our priorities, our mission-critical objectives that we need to solve for in the coming year. We arrived at this list through CSM leadership discussions and final input from individual contributors.

Big Rock 1: (Re)Define the CSM Role

Epic (GitLab Internal-Only)

The goal of the CSM is to drive growth. However, the role of the CSM has become increasingly broad over the past few years, deterring from the growth conversation with customers. As we have added more to the role (migration & infrastructure guidance, cross-functional escalation ownership, consultative support), the ability to focus as a CSM on growth has become increasingly challenging.

To continue to build a scalable CSM team focused on excellent customer experience and driving customer growth, we need to refine the role of the CSM. This initiative will include what a CSM is and what a CSM is not.

Key areas of exploration:

- 1. Definition by CSM segment: High-touch, Mid-touch, Scale
- 1. Reducing overlap: Looping in of support/timing
- 1. Infrastructure conversations and ownership
- 1. Escalation improvements; streamlining

Big Rock 2: Expertise in driving CI and DevSecOps adoption & expansion

Epic (GitLab Internal-Only)

In FY22 we put considerable focus into use case expansion. The team have developed a well-rounded understanding of the use cases, but have not been given the space needed to become experts in driving any one use case. In FY23 we will seek to become experts in driving CI and DevSecOps expansion and maturity, knowing these use cases are the key drivers for customer stickiness and growth.

Key areas of exploration:

- 1. Iteration on playbooks
- 1. Supporting materials
- 1. Webinars
- 1. Digital enablement/expansion strategies
- 1. Reporting & visualization
- 1. Maturity scoring (customer)

Big Rock 3: Deepen our customer engagement

Epic (GitLab Internal-Only)

The CSM relationship with the customer has been architected primarily on engagement with GitLab admins, who are not responsible for platform adoption or business case value. Due to the CSM being pigeon-holed into these admin conversations, we are often not engaging with the right people in order to ensure excellent customer experience, use case adoption and growth. In FY23 we will seek to engage the development team leads and key users of the GitLab platform early and often, to ensure consistent growth strategies with our customers.

Key areas of exploration:

1. Expectation setting: from presales
1. Defining engagement strategies for target personas
1. Supporting content creation and digital programs
1. Exec sponsor program
1. User groups/customer forums

SECTION: customer-success/csm/fy24.md

CSME (Customer Success Management and Engineering)

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

FY24 Annual OKRs (Big Rocks)

Objective: The 3 'big rocks' to take on in FY24 with the overall goal of moving our team forwards. These rocks need to move us forwards as a team and as individuals, enabling us to scale, be impactful, and be inspired/fulfilled in our roles.

What are 'big rocks'? As outlined in this article, they are our priorities, our mission-critical objectives that we need to solve for in the coming year. We arrived at this list through CSM leadership discussions and final input from individual contributors.

Big Rock 1: Invest in the team to drive customer value

Investing in the CSM team is a top priority, and this year we will provide team members with education and enablement to empower them in their role with customers and other GitLab team members, specifically related to:

- Cross-functional collaboration
- Executive engagement
- Sales approach best practices
- Book of business ownership
- CSMs will exit FY24 with skills to help them throughout their career, and they will be better equipped to drive customer results and ROI, through improved confidence, leadership, collaboration, and ownership.

Our goals with this big rock include the following initiatives:

- Develop and launch enablement materials for skills key to being a successful CSM:
- Neurodiversity awareness
- Cross-departmental collaboration
- Executive engagement and presence
- Sales expertise
- Strategic long-term planning
- Close gaps across CSM and Sales ICs and managers by establishing regular cadences and documenting agreed-upon expectations
- Invest in CSMs' personal and professional development through provided training, growth & development budget, and regular growth conversations
- Ensure fundamentals learned in onboarding are regularly reinforced with all members of the team
- Foster an inclusive environment for CSMs and elevate diversity as a core value

For more information and specifics, please review the epic for Big Rock 1 (GitLab-internal only), which includes quarterly OKRs for FY24.

Big Rock 2: Drive product adoption and growth for your customers
Epic for Big Rock 2

Equip team members to speak to product capabilities, value propositions, business impact, and help customers with use case adoption.

Big Rock 3: Know our customers
Epic for Big Rock 3 (GitLab-internal only)

Ensure our customers receive ongoing value through increasing product adoption and growth, aligned with the customer's desired business outcomes.

CSMs equipped to work as trusted advisors with our customers to achieve their objectives in a reportable, quantifiable way through a framework that also enables early and accurate identification of both opportunity and risk.

Examples:

Objective: increase developer productivity

How is/will productivity be measured?

- Measured through release volume and release frequency in the absence of being able to track all of DORA.

What are their technical milestones to get to this business outcome?

How many apps need to be completed by xxx to get to the intended business outcome of yyy?

What use cases adopted, and by when?

SECTION: customer-success/csm/issue-prioritization.md

The Customer Prioritization Framework is currently an MVC and in its initial pilot phase. Work in progress can be seen on the WG:Prioritization Framework issue board. For any questions or to collaborate, feel reach out to DRI @gweaver or join the ongoing bi-weekly sync

Dashboard

The issue prioritization dashboard is located in Sisense. The data is aggregated from the feedback template used when a customer or prospect has expressed interest in a feature.

How CSMs use the dashboard

You can filter dashboard by Customer Success Manager. This will give you all customer requested issues for a CSMs book of business. You can also filter dashboard by a specific customer or prospect. This will give you a customer specific view of their requested issues.

Cadence Calls

Utilize the Recently Opened and Recently Closed dashboard views during your customer cadence calls.

In the Recently Opened view, CSMs can confirm a customer requested issue has been prioritized by referencing the Deliverable column.

In the Recently Closed view, CSMs can share the recently released feature requests the customer has interest in. This can help drive frequency of GitLab upgrades.

Executive Business Reviews

Utilize the Customer Drill Down section during Executive Business Reviews to highlight trends in a customers specific feature requests. The Open User Requests view shows trends of how many open and closed requests the customer has. The Open User Requests by Issue/Epic Type shows trends of feature requests and bug fixes.

Top Issues/Epics

Customers will often ask "Are we the only customer interested in this feature?". To answer this, utilize the Top Issues/Epics Product Groups For section. This will give you a view of the most requested issues at GitLab.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/leadership-recurring-checkin.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

What is a Leadership Recurring Check-In Call?

The Leadership Recurring Check-In call is a strategic discussion with customer leadership to ensure we are progressing toward our success plan objectives together. While an Executive Business Review (EBR) aims to establish business goals and report on progress annually, the Leadership Recurring Check-In allows for a more focused conversation with leadership to allow for progress checks, and review the prioritization of objectives. It is less granular than a cadence call, but more focused than an EBR, and still has the aims of being strategic and requiring company leadership, even if they are not at the executive level.

CSMs should hold optional Leadership Recurring Check-Ins on a quarterly cadence with leadership within development and DevOps teams. These discussions should be anywhere from 30-60 minutes and allow time for the CSM to provide success plan updates and level-set on the customer's goals.

How to bring up a Leadership Recurring Check-In with your customers

An ideal time to schedule a recurring check-in call is following an EBR, since leadership should be present on the call and have a vested interest in scheduling a check-in call one quarter out. The CSM should bring up the topic of the Leadership Recurring Check-In as an opportunity to track progress toward the established goals during the EBR, and pose it as a conversation on both progress and prioritization of the goals as time passes.

Sample Agenda Template

- 1. Introductions
- 1. Goals and Objectives Summary Review
- 1. Current GitLab Adoption Metrics
 - 1. Progress Toward Goals
- 1. Product Discussion (Optional)
- 1. Recommendations & Next Steps (Value Stream Assessments, POVs, Enablement Sessions, etc.)

Goal-Setting Questions to Ask Stakeholders

- 1. Where would you like to be in 6 months?
- 1. Describe your current SDLC process.
- 1. Where are the gaps in your SDLC today?
- 1. What are your goals around DevOps for the next 6-12 months?

Goal-Affirming Items to Share with Stakeholders

- 1. Usage trends over the last 6-12 months

SECTION: customer-success/csm/onboarding.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Customer Onboarding is the beginning phase of the customer lifecycle.

Overview

The customer onboarding phase is critical to getting a customer started on a successful journey with GitLab. This is our opportunity to ensure the customer achieves value and success from the start of their GitLab usage.

Onboarding steps

The onboarding process should begin when the customer opportunity reaches stage "5-Negotiating" for Booked ARR in order to introduce the CSM while we have high-touch engagement to close the opportunity. Once an opportunity that will newly qualify a customer for CSM alignment reaches stage 5, a Gainsight CTA will be created for the CSM Manager to assign the customer to a CSM. The assigned CSM should then start the onboarding process with the rest of the account team.

.. NOTE: Please review the time to value metrics for target completion timeline.

Internal transition

The first step is completing the handoff from pre-sales to post-sales. This will ensure the entire account team is clear on the customer's status, and the CSM can be properly introduced to the customer. This sync on the background of the account is essential and must happen before the CSM is on a call with the customer, so the CSM has the full background and the account team approaches the call as a united front, already understanding the customer goals and working towards achieving them.

If a customer will be on Dedicated, the CSM should familiarize themselves with the best practices for CSMs of Dedicated Customers.

CSM intro email and onboarding

Digital programs will automate the Intro to GitLab CS program outlining what a CSM does, followed by the onboarding enablement emails for all CSM assigned customers, excluding PubSec. This will trigger for a customer when the onboarding playbook has been created. All emails come from a generic Customer Enablement GitLab email address, and each email is tokenized with the CSM name. Customers have the option to reply directly to the email which will email the CSM to schedule a call or ask questions. Each CSM will also be cc'd on all emails sent to their customers for visibility.

- Email 1: Introduction to GitLab CS Experience (what a CSM does)
- Email 2: Onboarding Email - Intro, first steps, how to get help
- Email 3: Onboarding Email - Security, backup and restore
- Email 4: Onboarding Email - Monitor GitLab, API and rate limits
- Email 5: Onboarding Email - Additional training and support

These emails will automatically be sent to any customer contacts who are labeled as a GitLab Admin, and at least one contact should have been labeled as part of the pre-sales process. It is recommended to label multiple contacts if possible as a GitLab Admin so they receive the emails as well, ensuring the enablement content is received.

Review email copy here (internal only).

Kickoff call

- Target time: within 14 days of customer start date

The kickoff call is the first conversation between the CSM and the customer. This is when the CSM describes their role to the customer, and starts their own discovery process to fill in details they don't have from the internal transition in order to start an effective engagement and create a success plan.

The goal of the kickoff call is to align on desired business outcomes, key upcoming milestones, and create clarity on our partnership as CSMs.

Which Deck Should I use for the Kickoff call?

CSMs select from the following templates for their kick off call, depending on the customer handover:

1. If a strategy roadmap was completed with the SAs, use this kickoff slide deck (internal only). Please click [here](#) for a video overview of how to best utilize the deck (private video on GitLab Unfiltered).
2. If not, use this kickoff slide deck (internal only), and is available as part of the onboarding CTA.

The CSM should review and revise this deck in advance of the kickoff call based on what they already know about the customer and what they are still looking to understand.

What should I know coming out of the Kickoff call?

Ideally, the following information has been collected in the presales process and we use the kickoff to confirm and build upon this knowledge. In the times that these questions are not known, we always seek to leave the kickoff with an understanding of the following?

1. Why did you buy GitLab? Ideally you've already answered this question in your handoff from pre-sales, so if that's the case, reframe the question to validate that you understand they purchased GitLab for X reason and confirm your understanding of what challenges the customer is looking to solve.
1. What other tools are you using? Understanding what the tool landscape is for the customer is crucial in being able to help them adopt GitLab in relation to their desired use cases. Try to write down their tool for each of the following use cases: SCM, CI, CD, Package, Security, Monitoring, Agile
1. What are your business goals? After they achieve their immediate goal of whatever they want to use GitLab for, what's next for them?
1. Are there other stakeholders to involve? Is there anyone else who would benefit from having business discussions with GitLab? CSMs should always have at least 2 regular contacts they speak with, ideally in line with our target personas.

In addition to the above questions, make sure to review the tasklist for the first cadence call to ensure you cover additional important items, such as support and training. It's also critical to ensure that customers (especially those that are self-managed) sign up for GitLab security alerts, which they can do by entering their email address in the "Sign up for security

notices" section of this page. CSMs can monitor whether or not their customers are signed up for security alerts by looking at the relevant SFDC reports for contacts (most customers will fall into this category) and leads. It is recommended to save versions of those SFDC reports with your preferred filters in your Personal Custom Reports folder in SFDC for efficiency and to avoid accidentally modifying the original reports. You can do this by opening the report, selecting "Save As", renaming the report, and saving it to "My Personal Custom Reports". From there, you can modify the report to include your desired filters. If a customer does not sign up for security alerts in between the kickoff call and the first cadence call, CSMs should revisit this topic in subsequent conversations and emphasize that opting in to these notifications will ensure the customer is aware of any action they may need to take to keep their instance(s) secure.

One of the most important action items coming out of the kickoff call is establishing the cadence call. The CSM should have the ongoing cadence call schedule determined with the customer by the end of the kickoff call, as well as a plan for the first cadence call.

CSM Journey Spreadsheet

CSMs are welcome to use a Customer Journey Spreadsheet (internal only) to identify the customer's entry point and better identify the enablement needed. The spreadsheet aims to cover the multiple onboarding steps we see as CSMs, from the infrastructure build review, to the required migration steps and expansion to DevSecOps. Scale and Growth CSMs are not recommended to create and maintain these spreadsheets.

Success plan development (document key attributes)

Once the kickoff call is complete, the CSM should have sufficient information to start developing the success plan. This is a critical step in successful onboarding and long-term customer engagement.

· NOTE: While the CSM should be able to create an effective first iteration of the success plan at this point in onboarding, the success plan is a living document, so the CSM should continue iterating the success plan throughout the customer lifecycle.

Please review the success plan handbook page for more details on how to do this.

1st Cadence Call: Future Growth Discussion & Checklist

· Target time: Within 30 days of customer start date

The first cadence call is typically the CSM's second conversation with the customer and when we start to deliver value through our efforts as a trusted advisor.

The completion of this second customer call marks the completion of customer onboarding, as we have collected all information needed and given the customer the tools they need to be successful going forward.

Once onboarding is complete, close the onboarding CTA and then move the customer into the Adoption phase of the customer lifecycle in Gainsight.

By accomplishing the following tasks, you'll know you have completed onboarding:

- ☐ Complete internal handoff, where CSM reviews the command plan, adoption goals, priorities, and stakeholders with the SAE/AE and SA
 - ☐ Assign GitLab Admin and/or other persona roles to primary contacts
 - ☐ Complete kickoff call, where the CSM:
 - ☐ Leads introductions (Less than 5 minutes)
 - ☐ Validates the customer's reason for purchase
 - ☐ Asks about any additional goals the customer has
 - ☐ Asks about the customer's DevSecOps toolstack
 - ☐ Asks about any additional customer stakeholders
 - ☐ Advises the customer on how to get [support as well as how to sign up for security alerts
 - ☐ Raises the awareness at the customer that they bookmark our page for platform/service changes and announcements (<https://about.gitlab.com/blog/categories/bulletin-board/>)
 - ☐ Complete initial draft of success plan, with the objective being their primary use case with the relevant [Stage Enablement playbook
 - ☐ Complete second call (first cadence), where the CSM:
 - ☐ Discusses how they will work with the customer towards their goals, collecting metrics for success, milestones/timelines, and establishing next steps
 - ☐ Discusses enablement opportunities (e.g. [workshops, Professional Services, GitLab documentation, etc.)
 - ☐ Shares available content for workshops and webinars and advocates for the customer to attend a session on Intro to GitLab and/or their primary use case
 - ☐ Discusses the monthly upgrade cadence for releases
 - ☐ (If self-managed) Discusses usage ping
 - ☐ Complete filling out any relevant fields in the Gainsight Attributes tab of the customer
- 360

If you haven't been able to achieve all of this by the end of the second call, document the reasons for the delay in your notes and aim to complete this by the next call. Please note the onboarding CTA currently asks you to log the First Value Date (time-to-first-value) if the customer does not have service ping enabled; if you don't have this information yet, and everything else is complete, mark the onboarding as done regardless, and continue to work towards understanding the customer's progress towards first-value separately, logging it when known.

Time to Value Metrics

The Time to Value KPIs are developed to help us understand key facts about how we are serving our customers, and how we could improve. Below are the processes for how CSMs should update and track their Time to Value KPIs. For definitions, please see Time to Value KPIs. For data visualization, see Customer Onboarding Dashboard.

Time to Engage

Goal: 14 days

Required CSM action: log the first Timeline entry (Call or Meeting)

How is it calculated:

Time to Engage is the number of days between the Onboarding CTA Start Date and the date of the first Timeline call or meeting entry. Time to Engage Calculation = Timeline call or meeting entry Date - Onboarding CTA Start Date. Example: If the Onboarding CTA Start Date is 2020-01-01 and the first call was 2020-01-12, then the Time to Engage would be 11 days.

Note: If the date of the first Timeline call or meeting is the same day as the Onboarding CTA Start Date, Time to Engage = 0. If the date of the first Timeline call or meeting is BEFORE the Onboarding CTA Start Date, that account will appear as a "0" for reporting.

Why is this metric important?

Helps determine the time it takes to first engagement with the customer. Engagement is defined as the first CSM meeting with the customer.

Time to First Value

Goal: 30 days

Required CSM action: confirm Cloud License data is in Gainsight, if not, then manually update the First Value Date

How is it calculated:

Time to First Value is calculated by taking the Original Contract Date and subtracting First Value Date, which is a manual input on the customer's Attributes section of the C360.

If Cloud License data is in Gainsight, the First Value Date will be automatically populated by the system when Known License Utilization meets or exceeds 10%. If Cloud License data is not available, it is the responsibility of the CSM to manually update the date field based on their best estimate.

Why is this metric important?

Allows visibility into customer usage of GitLab. Customer is considered to have met first value when at least 10% of their Production licenses are activated.

A few pointers to determine best estimate for self-managed customers

Note: This is not a holistic list

- Is GitLab installed and ready to be used by the customers?
- Is user management configured correctly and are users able to use the product?
- In case of a migration: Is the migration finished or is the migration in progress and are migrated users already able to use the product?
- If the customer has upgraded from CE/Starter or if the customer has been assigned a CSM due to growth but was already a customer, then the Time to Value is the same as the date a CSM is assigned.

Time to Onboard

Goal: 45 days

Required CSM action: Close the Onboarding CTA

How is it calculated:

Time to Onboard is the difference between Onboarding CTA Start Date and the date the Onboarding CTA is closed. For example, the Onboarding CTA Start Date is 2020-08-15 and the Onboarding CTA was closed on 2020-09-18, the Time to Onboard would be 34 days.

Why is this metric important?

Helps determine the length of time it took to complete all of the onboarding tasks associated with a customer.

Instance/Namespace Time to Value Metrics

Each Time-to-Value metric is calculated by the difference between the Subscription Start Date and the date the product usage metric was achieved. All metrics are calculated at the subscription level. These metrics do not run back historically, and are only calculated for subscriptions that began from February 2022 onwards.

- Time to License Utilization (10%, 50%, 80%): The first date the instance reached 10%, 50%, and 80% license utilization.
- Time to DevSecOps Deployment: The first date the instance reached green health for DevSecOps deployment ($\geq 20\%$).
- Time to SCM Deployment: The first date the instance reached green health for SCM deployment ($\geq 40\%$).
- Time to CI Deployment: The first date the instance reached green health for CI deployment ($\geq 25\%$).

Note: There are cases where the time-to-value metric may result in a negative value. This can occur if a company has begun using their instance and reached the time-to-value metric prior to their subscription start date (i.e., they achieved value during their trial or if they were on a free instance).

Command Plan

A Command Plan is used as a living pre-sales document, and its objectives are converted into Gainsight Success Plan objectives at the time of account onboarding.

Command Plan Attainment Reporting in Gainsight

To ensure the customer attains their original purchase intent, the field can now monitor the Customer Health Dashboard in Gainsight, which provides quick snapshot into the following fields and information related to an account's Command Plan:

- Solution (i.e. Platform, Security, Automate Software Delivery, etc.)
- Primary Capability (i.e. Agile, CI, DevSecOps, etc.)
- Primary Value Driver (i.e. Reduce Security & Compliance risk, Increase operational efficiencies, etc.)
- Associated Score Color (i.e. Red, Yellow, Green)
- Metrics - Filled in by Sales (What is the business case? Have you quantified the challenge(s) they are having and the impact to the organization? What quantifiable metrics / measurements have been identified? How will you prove the business benefits of the solution?)
- Identify Pain - Filled in by Sales (The problems created by the customers current state. What

are the biggest business and technical pains? Are those pains resulting in lost productivity, reduced revenues, increased costs, etc.? How severe is the pain? Does the customer perceive that the pain of change is less than the pain of doing nothing and sticking with the status quo? Is there a compelling event that adds to the pain?)

- Date CP Use Case Turned Green - Stamped date to identify the exact date the customer attained their original purchase intent.

This report should help CSMs and Sales track progress toward their customer's goals as recorded in the Command Plan in Salesforce prior to purchase, while also being able to help the customer and Account Teams understand the customer's achievement of their primary use case.

Onboarding delays

Given the importance of onboarding to the customer's journey and our ability to drive success, we want to move through it as quickly as possible. If onboarding is delayed, either because of something on the GitLab side or the customer side, we need to document the reasons and take appropriate action.

Document the delay

The details around why onboarding is delayed should be documented in the following places:

- Onboarding CTA comments field
- Update timeline entry, with a revised CSM Sentiment

Risk and triage

If the delay is caused by the customer (e.g. disinterest, lack of engagement/"going dark") then the account has risk and should be flagged.

- Add an At-Risk timeline entry
- Communicate the customer risk
- Determine if an account escalation is required.

Gainsight for Onboarding

CTA Creation Criteria

CSM-assigned accounts: When a customer signs at or reaches the CSM-assigned threshold, a Call To Action (CTA) is triggered within Gainsight.

If the CSM field is not populated, a CTA is created for the CSM Manager. Once populated, an onboarding CTA is kicked off for the CSM. While the opening of an onboarding CTA is an automated process, it can also be created manually by going to the Cockpit, clicking + CTA and then choosing the onboarding playbook.

CTA Content and Process

The CTA guides the CSM through the initial customer engagement, covering the topics discussed in this handbook page.

CSMs and CSM Managers can use Gainsight dashboards to manage customers currently in onboarding and to ensure progress is being made, as well as report on metrics achieved at the end of each quarter.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/pto.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

As part of GitLab's paid time off policy, team members are encouraged to take time off. However, as customer-facing team members this can feel difficult, so this page is intended to help guide CSMs to ensure they can regularly take time off, avoid burnout, and keep their customers successful.

Before you go

To take PTO, please follow the guidelines in the PTO policy and be sure to enter your time off in Time Off by Deel.

Before your PTO begins, please follow these additional guidelines:

1. Establish coverage for when you'll be out.
1. Communicate your time off to colleagues.
1. Notify customers and adjust plans as necessary.
1. Set up your email autoresponder.
1. Review our PTO communication guidelines.

Establish Coverage

When a CSM is out of office, they can rely on their SAEs/AEs and/or SAs to lead customer meetings or respond to requests. Make sure your account teams know in advance that you'll be out and for how long so they can be prepared.

You can ask another CSM to cover for you as well, but they likely don't have the same context as the account team, so you'll need to brief them on any important initiatives.

For any specific customer needs (escalating tickets, logging issues, etc.), the CSM should rely on either the SA or backup CSM, and higher-level or sales-related items should be handled by the SAE/AE.

Be sure to confirm with whoever will be covering for you the dates you'll be out to ensure they don't also have PTO scheduled or other conflicts. Then, add them and their coverage responsibilities into Time Off by Deel.

Backup CSMs

Backup CSMs should not be expected to support the entire book of business of the vacationing

CSM; however, they should stay abreast of what is going on with those accounts during the coverage period. For example, you should respond to any customers that reach out to you, but it's also recommended to spend 5 minutes each day of coverage checking if the CSM has been pinged in either Slack or in GitLab.com collaboration projects. Here are some tips on how to do this quickly and easily:

Slack:

1. Use the search bar and search the person's name, then review any pings they may have gotten and answer appropriately.
1. Alternatively, to automatically be notified if the CSM is pinged, click on GitLab at the top left of your Slack, go to Preferences, and enter the CSM's Slack handle in the My keywords box. (Remember to remove this when they return!)

GitLab.com:

1. To see what pings the CSM has received, go to GitLab.com and in the search bar search the CSM's GitLab handle.
1. Then, filter by issues and sort by descending creation date and review any new issues.
1. If you're familiar with what accounts the CSM has, you can also go to the region's collaboration project group, go to the issue list, sort by descending creation date, and review if any new issues have been opened in their customers' projects. This is useful to catch things if the customer does not tag the CSM but is not an expectation.

Please note that while any simple questions or requests should be answered when possible, if it's more complicated or will require more work than you are able to do, please still comment in response to the customer letting them know that their CSM is on PTO and will return on X date. This way, the customer has an update and an idea of when they might expect an answer. This is especially helpful on GitLab.com as there is no native out of office responder.

Time Off by Deel will ping you the day before the CSM returns. Be sure to let the CSM know about any requests or situations that occurred when they return so they can follow up, as well as any actions you took while they were out.

Americas East PTO Buddy Program

As of July 2021, the Americas East CSM team is trialing a program where each CSM is paired with another CSM to be each other's regular PTO backup. The goal of this program is to allow the CSM's customers to become familiar with the backup CSM so they feel like they can rely on them, as well as to allow the backup CSM to become familiar with the customers so they can better cover any ongoing or new initiatives.

Additionally, it removes the uncertainty of having to ask the wider team if anyone is available to cover for them. It will also allow SAs to focus on SA work, as they should typically only be involved in pre-sales motions, and as such they may not even have more background on current customer initiatives than a backup CSM would.

Hopefully as an additional benefit, CSMs will have more exposure to how other team members work and what challenges and initiatives customers have, which will improve our team's efficiency and diversity of thought.

As the East team continues to trial this program, they will share feedback and insights to the wider CSM organization.

Communicate your time off plan to colleagues

In accordance with our "no ask, must tell" policy, ensure that you are informing the relevant team members of your out-of-office plan. This includes:

- SAE/AE and SA for the accounts you cover
- Backup CSM
- Your manager (via Time Off by Deel)

Please ensure that everyone knows about the following items during your scheduled PTO:

- Customer meetings
- Ongoing initiatives that will need attention
- Who will be responsible for different types of customer communication (e.g. technical issues, license concerns, etc.)

Notify customers and make necessary changes

Reach out to all of your customers to inform them of your upcoming time off, and who will be covering their account while you are away. Preferably this should be done during the cadence call prior to your PTO starting and reiterated with a follow-up email, but if that is not possible then send an email with all of the relevant details.

If a cadence call falls during your PTO, you can decide to either cancel or reschedule. If there is an emergency or the call cannot be moved, the people covering for you should lead the call. It is the CSM's responsibility to prep in advance whomever will lead the call.

Email templates

To simplify communicating out of office details to customers, email templates are available. These ensure that all of the relevant information is provided. Please use these as guidance for your customer communication when OOO.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/retrospectives.md

Retrospectives

Program Objective

The objective of this retrospective program is to facilitate a structured and collaborative process for reflecting on accounts where significant churn or risk is present, identify areas for improvement, implementing actionable changes to enhance future performance and share learnings across the organization.

Scope

As a part of our retrospective process, when there is significant churn or risk to a customer account, the Customer Success Manager should own the retrospective process and align with their sales (AE/ASM), Solutions Architect (SA), Professional Services (PS) or Renewals Manager (RM) partners throughout. The goal of the retrospective is to talk through what went well, what didn't go well, and what can be improved for next time.

Deals to Consider:

1. Customer Ultimate Downgrade
2. GitHub Competitive Loss
3. Complex or Non-Standard Commercial Terms
4. Risk Intervention Wins/Losses
5. Account Management Challenges
6. Growth Market Wins/Losses
7. Technical Product Challenges or Gaps
8. New Process or Plays Wins/Losses

Guiding Principles

In order to generate the best results from a retrospective we must embody GitLab's CREDIT values and the following elements must be present:

1. A safe environment for feedback
2. A plan for advancing discussion from facts to conclusions

Although this retrospective program is predominately performed async it's critical that all parties agree and acknowledge that no one person is at fault and that a successful outcome is tied to learning and taking action to better address challenges or opportunities in the future.

Establishing a Safe Environment

Retrospectives are inherently conversations about what went well and what didn't go well when discussing churn or risk. While it's easy to talk about what went well, what didn't go well can be a touchy subject. Without a safe environment, issues may go unmentioned, and the team won't improve as rapidly as they otherwise could. To collect as much feedback as possible, we recommend that you observe the following:

1. All retrospectives should have an impartial moderator. This moderator actively attempts to remain objective and is focused on guiding the conversation forward throughout the meeting. If participants feel that the moderator has a stake in the conversation, they may feel as though it is not safe to voice dissent or share concerns.

Normally a manager should act as this moderator. In some circumstances, the moderator may feel a strong need or desire to participate in the conversation. In that case, they should make it clear that their participation is as an individual participant, not as the moderator. If the moderator wants to take a very active role in the discussion, they should find a peer, Director, or other member of the group willing to moderate.

2. Emotions are not only allowed in retrospectives, but they should also be encouraged. Emotional language (·I was angry when·, ·It made me sad that·) not only helps convey

intensity, it also helps expose issues that may have been difficult to sort out otherwise. Make sure all participants know they are free to express their feelings, although we do expect them to stay consistent with our values.

3. When possible, all parties should be present. No one should have to worry about sharing concerns or experiences because another party isn't there to represent their side of the story. This includes stakeholders from any team, where necessary - if someone's role or contributions are going to be discussed, they should have the opportunity to contribute to the retrospective as well.

4. Use an issue to collect feedback asynchronously. Consider using the retro template to collect feedback asynchronously. This allows everyone involved to think about and record their feedback on their own time. Please tag the appropriate team members within the template to add their comments prior to the sync meeting.

5. Schedule Sync meeting. After a particularly difficult churn or risk situation, or when there's a strong risk that emotions will be running high, it's almost always worth the cost to have everyone in a video meeting to talk through the retrospective in real-time. The CSM should schedule the retro with their manager included as well as sales, PS, SA, RM, etc involved with the customer.

Having a Plan

It's easy for retrospectives to go off the rails if there isn't a good plan for collecting actionable insights. If the moderator doesn't guide the conversation successfully, the retrospective could be dominated by a few 'loud voices' or could stay focused on the facts and feelings about the past iteration without drawing any conclusions. To make sure the conversation is productive, we recommend that you have a clear agenda for the conversation. The moderator for the retrospective is then responsible for ensuring the agenda is followed and completed. While the specific nature of this agenda will vary from group to group, we recommend something that follows this general pattern:

1. Introduction - Remind people of the purpose of the retrospective, and that the conversation should be scoped to the churn/risk situation under review. Ensure everyone understands the rest of the agenda.

2. Gather data - Don't try to draw any conclusions up front, simply collect facts. This can be done via the Restrospective Template by soliciting themes and adding context.

3. Generate insights - Now that you have all of the facts, try to work together to identify patterns or causal relationships (because we did x, y happened).

4. Decide what to do - With the insights firmly in hand, it should be fairly easy to identify action items for the team. This could be things to change with our process, it could be things to experiment with, or any other number of things. Coming out of a retro, it should be clear on next steps and who own those.

5. Close the retrospective - Make sure everyone who participated receives positive feedback about how they helped create these results. Observe any surprising or unexpected results from the retrospective, which confirms that the retrospective was valuable. Make sure all of the action items are appropriately assigned to one or more group members with clear expectations

for when they should be completed.

Learnings and Recommendations

Learnings from each retrospective will be reviewed and shared via the CS Key Reviews and QBRs along with recommendations to improve risk identification, mitigation or our products.

SECTION: customer-success/csm/rhythm.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

CSM Rhythm of Business

A successful CSM is pulled into various tasks across multiple territories and accounts. It is critical for a CSM to manage time effectively and concentrate on tasks that have the most positive impact for GitLab and the customer.

The CSM Rhythm of Business has been designed to focus CSM efforts on the most fruitful daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, and yearly tasks.

This chart, not only provides the task information, but also the purpose behind each task and the associated handbook pages with additional information.

Click here for a downloadable version of the chart below.

<iframe allowfullscreen frameborder="0" style="width:640px; height:480px"
src="https://lucid.app/documents/embeddedchart/fd53487f-143b-420f-ae66-9e73f3505ef2"
id="LvjcIsjZrJBQ"></iframe>

SECTION: customer-success/csm/roleplays.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

Roleplay Scenarios

- Success planning and uncovering strategic goals
 - "Ticklish Licorice" scenario
 - Customer info sheet
 - CSM info sheet
 - This scenario can be done 1:1 where the person acting as the customer can choose to be George or Alicia, but this scenario can be extra impactful in a group setting with multiple people acting as different customer personas.

- "Green Grass Medical" scenario
 - Background info
 - This roleplay is part of the "CSM Building Success Plans" EdCast course
- Stage expansion
 - Secure
 - Customer info sheet
 - CSM info sheet
 - Verify
 - Customer info sheet
 - CSM info sheet
- Booking an EBR
 - Customer info sheet
 - CSM info sheet
- Onboarding/customer kickoffs
 - Kickoff
 - Rubric
 - Part of Sales Quick Start
 - TODO build scenario and roles
- Pre-sales
 - Command of the Message
 - Part of Sales Quick Start
 - Buyer info sheet
 - Seller info sheet

Customer Personas

These role-play scenarios are designed to practice identifying and gaining access to people in the listed personas.

Development Lead or Other Stakeholder

The defined persona for somebody in a leadership role within the customer's development or engineering department.

- CSM role
- Customer role
- Post-scenario review

Software Security Lead

The defined persona for somebody responsible for a customer's application security.

- CSM role
- Customer role
- Post-scenario review

Development Lead Kickoff

Initial meeting between the CSM and an identified contact who is a development lead persona.

- CSM role
- Customer role
- Post-scenario review

SECTION: customer-success/csm/service-ping-faq.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

What is Service Ping

Service Ping generates customer analytics on self-managed instances that enable GitLab to collaborate with our customers to accelerate value attribution, achieve return-on-investment (ROI) goals, and accomplish business outcomes with the GitLab solution. Specifically, it helps GitLab understand product adoption to:

1. Ensure adoption is aligned to business outcomes (i.e., goals, timelines, etc).
1. Understand usage for industry and best practice recommendations
1. Recommend features or capabilities that maximize solution value based on:
 - Gaps in adoption
 - New features or capabilities that can be leveraged
1. Enable User Cohorts and GitLab DevOps Score that provides an overview of customers' adoption of Concurrent DevOps from planning to monitoring
1. Track usage and adoption over time

For the definition of each metric, please see our Service Ping Metrics Dictionary.

Links to other ways Service Ping is used by Customer Success

How Does Service Ping Help Me?

Service Ping provides insights into your teams' usage of GitLab to enable you to understand output, maturity, and potential improvement areas across your instance. In understanding these key platform usage metrics, we can together be strategic in our roadmap for enablement and growth planning.

- As a benefit of having the service ping active, GitLab lets you analyze the users' activities over time of your GitLab installation.
- As a benefit of having the service ping active, GitLab provides you with The DevOps Score, which gives you an overview of your entire instance's adoption of Concurrent DevOps from planning to monitoring.
- You will get better, more proactive guidance when working with a Customer Success Manager.
- You will get insight and advice into how to get the most value out of their investment in GitLab.
- You get a report that illustrates how they compare against other similar organizations (anonymized), with specific advice and recommendations on how to improve their DevOps processes.

Commonly Asked Questions and Concerns

1. What information is sent via service ping?

GitLab collects product usage data from self-managed GitLab instances (Community Edition and Enterprise Edition) through a service ping, you can view a sample [here](#). Please see [GitLab Privacy Policy](#) for additional details.

2. It's a corporate security policy that we don't send data to vendors

GitLab can collaborate with you to understand your security controls and regulatory requirements that you have to meet. We've seen several risk-mitigating solutions where similar concerns regarding "outbound data transfers", and data leaving a secured boundary. Are there specific team members from security/compliance/privacy organizations that might provide additional insights? We understand your concerns and would be happy to have a call with our respective security teams to help resolve issues you may have. Before our call, GitLab will request you provide the specific compliance requirements you may have.

3. Is there a way we can share this data manually so that we can review it before it goes out?

Yes, you are able to extract this information manually and review prior to sending to GitLab. Here are the steps:

1. Login to your GitLab instance as administrator
1. Navigate to the admin section of the Interface by clicking the "wrench" at the top navigation ribbon of the homepage
1. At the left navigation panel, hover over the "Settings" ·> and click on "Metrics and Profiling"
1. When the Metrics and Profiling page populates, scroll down to the "Usage Statistics" segment of the page and click on the "Expand" button at the right-hand side.
1. Click on "Preview payload" button
1. A JSON formatted output of the data that is sent from GitLab instances to gitlab.com when allowed will be displayed in a pop-up.
Copy and paste this information into a text file, encrypt and send to GitLab or upload over SSH/HTTPS to the customer collaboration for your organization that's securely hosted on gitlab.com

4. Can customers visualize the data?

Yes. GitLab provides multiple ways to access and visualize Service Ping data:

- Manual access via REST API:

You can export the Service Ping data manually through GitLab's REST API. This enables direct inspection of the raw payload.

- GitLab Service Ping Dashboard:

GitLab Customer Success has developed a dedicated Service Ping Dashboard that allows you to track and visualize historical Service Ping metrics via a GitLab Pages site. The dashboard:

- Fetches Service Ping data via the API.
- Stores historical data over time.

- Generates interactive graphs.
- Updates weekly via GitLab CI/CD.
- Categorizes metrics and includes search/autocomplete for easy exploration.
- Automatically displays metric descriptions, trends and metadata.

This tool helps customers gain deeper insights into adoption trends, monitor key DevOps metrics over time, and prepare visual reports for stakeholders.

5. How do we ensure that you don't change what's in the payload?

Our documentation shows all usage statistics and content that is sent back to GitLab. When we change / update product analytics you can view the exact JSON payload in the administration panel. To view the payload: Navigate to the Admin Area > Settings > Metrics and profiling. Expand the Usage statistics section. Click the Preview payload button.

6. Our security team will have to sign off first

You can inspect the data and have your security team review it. They can continue to monitor (via ELK stack) that GitLab is not breaking security policy with new releases. We invite you to ship this data to an internal ELK stack, and sanitize it before sending to your GitLab Customer Success Manager. If we can get your security team to review and approve, we can fully automate this process so you don't have to go to the trouble.

7. We have network isolation and there is no way for usage to get out of their network

We respect your organizations' network security policies and restrictions and understand there are situations where it is not feasible or technically possible to submit service ping over the Internet. If Service Ping is blocked by a firewall, load balancer, or proxy, you might consider modifying your network configuration to un-block the Service Ping payload from being sent to GitLab.

If you see value in sharing Service Ping data and it's not technically possible for you to do so directly, GitLab can provide you instructions to share the data manually, including allowing you to sanitize certain data as preferred.

8. How do I disable service ping?

Free Self-Managed instances (CE and EE edition): If you want to deactivate this feature, go to the Settings page of your administration panel and uncheck the Service Ping checkbox.
Paid Self-Managed instances (EE edition): You may partially deactivate Service Ping by unchecking the Service Ping checkbox of your administration panel. However, certain Service Ping metrics related to subscriptions and customer success services can only be deactivated via support or through a sales representative. Details can be found in our Customer Product Usage Information.

You can view the payload at `"/admin/applicationsettings/metricsandprofiling"` in the Usage Statistics section and press the "View Payload" button.

Product Documentation: Deactivate the Service Ping

Important Documentation links

- 1. Admin Settings for Service Ping
- 1. Usage Statistics Collected
- 1. Network Configuration
- 1. Accessing Service Ping through REST API

SECTION: customer-success/csm/stage-adoption.md

View the CSM Handbook homepage for additional CSM-related handbook pages.

{{% alert title="2023-06-15 Note" color="warning" %}}

The approach described below is no longer in active use. The Use Case Adoption Scoring page should be referenced for thresholds and information on the methodology CSMs use for measuring adoption of use cases.

{{% /alert %}}

As part of the CSM's mandate to drive stage adoption and expansion with customers, we need to define exactly what it means to adopt a stage at GitLab. For more information on how stage expansion is recorded and reported on, please visit this page

The detail below is a guide to defining what it takes to say a customer has adopted that stage within GitLab. We define stage adoption as >25% of the account using a stage as defined below. Less than 25% (roughly) is presumed to be a pilot or work in progress toward a significant foothold of a stage providing value within the company.

Manage

Using 2 of the following:

- Using Code Analytics and Insights within GitLab.
- Using Value Stream Management within GitLab.

Usage Discovery Questions:

- 1. How do your admins monitor changes to user permission levels?
- 1. How do you keep track of which users have access to certain groups within GitLab?
- 1. How are you measuring developer cycle time?
- 1. How do you measure efficiencies within a group or project?

Plan

- Using Issue Tracking and/or Epics across 50% of teams.

Usage Discovery Questions:

- 1. What tools do you use to organize, plan and track project work?

1. Describe your issue and epic workflow.

Create

If there is no data currently being recorded for your customer in version.gitlab.com, you can ask whether they are:

- Using GitLab for git repo storage and code review (MR's).

Using data from version.gitlab.com and the Metrics Dictionary you can determine if the customer is doing the following:

- Using Merge Requests as part of the development lifecycle. (counts.mergerequests)
- Increase in projects with repositories with continuous growth over 3 months (counts.projectswithrepositoriesenabled)
- Increase in source control pushes/commits with continuous growth over 3 months (counts.sourcecodepushes)

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. Where do you manage your code base?
1. What processes do you follow for code reviews?

Verify

If there is no data currently being recorded for your customer in version.gitlab.com, you can ask whether they have:

- Made instance level shared Runner(s) available.
- More than 25% of teams or projects are using GitLab CI/CD.
- When 75+% of pipelines are using GitLab CI/CD.

Using data from version.gitlab.com and the Metrics Dictionary you can determine if the customer is doing the following:

- Made instance level shared Runner(s) available. (gitlabsharedrunnersenabled)
- Using Continuous Integration (CI) with continuous growth over 3 months (ciinternalpipelines)
- Using CI Runners to build pipelines (counts.cibuilds)

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. What types of Runners are you using today? (shared, group, specific)
1. What tools are you using for continuous integration?

Package

- Using one or more of our registries (Package Registry, Container Registry, Helm Registry).

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. What tools do you use for package management?
1. What do you use to maintain Docker images?
1. Do you use the GitLab Container Registry to manage Helm Charts?

Secure

If there is no data currently being recorded for your customer in version.gitlab.com, you can ask whether they have:

- Using one of more of our security testing tools (SAST, DAST, Container Scanning, Dependency Scanning) with continuous growth over 3 months

Using data from version.gitlab.com and the Metrics Dictionary you can determine if the customer is doing the following:

- Using one of more of our security testing tools (SAST, DAST, Container Scanning, Dependency Scanning) with continuous growth over 3 months
- SAST jobs (counts.sastjobs)
- DAST jobs (counts.dastjobs)
- Dependency scanning jobs (counts.dependencycscanningjobs)
- License management jobs (counts.licensemanagementjobs)
- Secret detection jobs (counts.secretDetectionjobs)
- Container scanning jobs - counts.containerscanningjobs

Usage Discovery Questions:

1. What do you use to scan your application source code and binaries?
1. Do you analyze your running web application for known runtime vulnerabilities?
1. What do you use to check your Docker images for known vulnerabilities?
1. Do you